



A: You have to just focus on your work. There will be challenges of debt going up but that is a part of the story. When you put money in manufacturing, changes will take place on technology or regulation or anything else.

One must be ready for all this. From a debt point of view, we raised \$35 billion when there was no current account convertibility. It was our job to develop the Vedanta brand. We must create value and we have done that well. Vedanta is an ambassador in the international market.

Q: You have faced a big problem with the copper plant in Tamil Nadu. When do you expect production to start? (This plant is owned by Sterlite Copper, a Vedanta Group company. Housed in Thoothukudi, it has remained closed since May 2018. There were protests

“Our focus on natural resources and, beyond that, technology will help existing businesses. There is no diversion for us at this point”

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and a police firing incident that led to civilian deaths. Vedanta went legal with the issue and finally, the Supreme Court dismissed the review petition that sought reopening of the plant. The court’s view was that there were environmental violations).

A: Frankly, this is not the only issue on copper. Nobody wants copper production globally. It was the first copper smelter and now is not operational. I have learnt a lot from this development and also moved ahead. We have tried our best but that said, it is left to the government to decide.

As a responsible player, we have not defaulted on payment and I am hopeful something positive will emerge. At the same time, this is a very small part of all our Vedanta businesses. I can only say—let things happen when they have to. It is important to move on. **BT**

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